The Shadow Theatre

Behind the heavy proscenium curtain lies an intimate theatre of light and shade. Three Venetian oil lamps hang suspended from an iron rail above the stage, casting the sharp profiles of articulated brass puppets across the taut linen screen. Here, the early masters practiced the art of silhouettes to convey silent ciphers.

When the raiders fled through this hall, they left the silhouettes scattered across the boards. To awaken the screen, arrange the brass figures along the beam between the flames. When the shadow of the tower and the crescent align, hold this page against a lantern: the light passing through both faces will bring the secret cipher into focus.

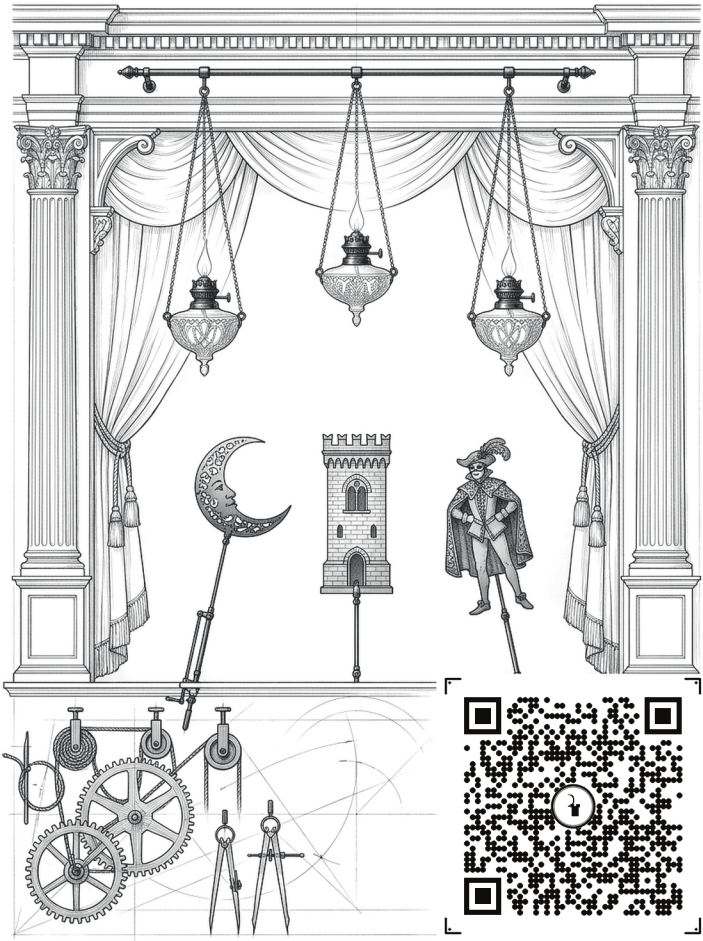
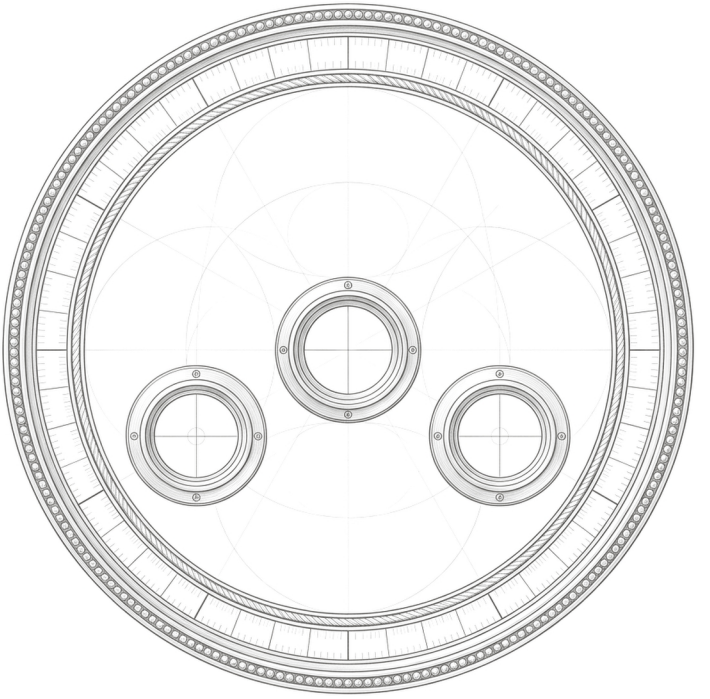


Plate XIV – Apparato per il Teatro delle Ombre (Tower III). Articulated brass silhouettes and room seal.

The Disc and the Vow

In the autumn of 1970, before our order parted ways, we cast this disc of bronze to seal a solemn vow. Its twenty-four engraved spokes divide the hours of the night and the zodiac. Three small apertures were pierced at the exact angles where the stage lamps burn. Held up to a candle, the light shining through both faces reveals the secret word of our covenant.

A.



Instructions for the Flame

1. In a darkened room, place a single lit candle or light behind this page.

2. Hold Sheet 23 upright between your eyes and the flame, with this disc facing you.

3. Look through the three pierced apertures: the light shining from behind will align with the stage lamps of the front face, revealing the secret letters of our vow.